

MERIDIAN HEALTH PLAN

Utilization Management | Notice of Adverse Benefit Determination

Date of Notice: 2026-07-10

Member: HAAG, ANTIONE | Member ID: MHP-89EDED81

Reference / Auth #: PA-2026-0710-91903

Ordering Provider: Priya Natarajan, MD — Cedar Grove Family Medicine

Requested Service: MRI Lumbar Spine without contrast (CPT 72148)

Diagnosis: M54.50 — Low back pain

Determination: DENIED

Denial Reason Code: MN-03 — Conservative Therapy Requirement Not Met

Rationale: Under Medical Policy MP-RAD-014, Section 2.1, lumbar spine MRI requires low back pain persisting six (6) weeks or longer AND a documented failed trial of conservative therapy (physical therapy, NSAID/analgesic pharmacotherapy, or a supervised home exercise program). The record as submitted does not document a completed conservative therapy trial. The request is denied as not medically necessary.

Your Appeal Rights

You may submit a written appeal within 180 days of the date of this notice. A peer-to-peer review with a plan medical director may be requested within 14 days. Submit appeals to: Meridian Health Plan, Attn: Appeals Unit, PO Box 22140.